

Boult Audio BassBox X500 Experiential Review

Budget-friendly soundbar for small rooms

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The world of soundbars is rife with competition, and brands often walk a tightrope between affordability and performance. Boult Audio, known for its budget-friendly audio products, throws its hat into the soundbar ring with the BassBox X500, promising thumping bass and an immersive audio experience. But can it truly deliver a home theatre experience without breaking the bank?

Build and Design

At first glance, the Boult Audio BassBox X500 offers an understated elegance. Its minimalist, rectangular frame blends seamlessly into modern entertainment setups. Boult opted for a matte black finish, which not only looks sleek but also avoids the pitfalls of fingerprint smudges and dust collection that can plague glossy surfaces. The dimensions make it compact enough to fit neatly under a TV or even be mounted on a wall. The clean edges and mesh grille on the front add a dash of modern aesthetics, while the soft LED lights on the front panel subtly indicate volume levels and input modes.

But it's not just about looks. There's a reassuring weight to the soundbar that hints at the solid build quality. Boult's decision to keep things

minimal works well in its favor — it's the kind of soundbar that doesn't need to stand out visually because it lets the audio do the talking.

Connectivity and Features

When it comes to connectivity, Boult has opted for a straightforward, no-frills approach. The BassBox X500 supports Bluetooth 5.0 for wireless connectivity, and you can also connect via AUX, HDMI ARC, or USB, depending on your setup. For those with more advanced audio setups, the absence of an optical input might be noticeable, but for the average user, this won't likely be a dealbreaker.

The remote control that comes bundled with the soundbar is basic but functional. You can adjust the bass, treble, and volume levels, but there's no sign of presets or advanced sound modes like cinema or music. Simplicity seems to be the theme here, and while

that works for some, more seasoned audiophiles might find the lack of customization options limiting.

What's impressive, however, is the ease with which the BassBox X500 connects to devices. Bluetooth pairing is quick and reliable, and the HDMI ARC input ensures seamless integration with your TV. For most users, this hassle-free setup will be a big plus.

Bass that packs a punch

Now, let's get to the heart of the matter — the sound quality. The BassBox X500 is aptly named, as it doesn't shy away from pushing the lower frequencies. The 2.1-channel system, supported by a built-in subwoofer, pumps out some seriously heavy bass. This is where Boult has put its signature stamp on the soundbar, focusing on delivering that deep, room-shaking low-end that bass enthusiasts crave.

Watching action movies is where this soundbar shines. Explosions have that satisfying rumble, and car chases feel more intense thanks to the weighty bass response. During a screening of *Mad Max: Fury Road*, the soundbar did a commendable job of keeping up with the relentless pace of the action. The subwoofer handled the heavy-duty sound effects without distorting, adding a palpable layer of excitement to the overall experience.

However, the sound profile isn't as balanced as one might hope. The focus on bass often leads to a slight compromise in the mids and highs. While dialogue is clear, it sometimes gets overshadowed by the powerful low-end, especially during intense sequences. Similarly, while watching *The Witcher*, the soundbar handled ambient noises and background music well, but Geralt's gruff dialogue lacked the clarity I would have liked. **d**

